of censorship and Chinese control over academic activities within the institutes.[63]

Connected to this university activism are the ways in which Chinese students studying at overseas universities not only are monitored by Beijing to ensure that they don't engage in anti-Chinese activities but are organized in countries like Australia to serve as pressure groups drowning out negative images of China.[64] The Chinese Students and Scholars Association keeps tabs on Chinese studying or researching abroad, mobilizing them when need be. Clashes between anti-Chinese and pro-Chinese students have roiled campuses in Australia, while a Chinese student at the University of Maryland in the United States suffered online harassment in China after a graduation speech in which she praised the environment of freedom she encountered in America.[65] Nor do agents of the Chinese government hesitate to target foreign scholars who expose its interference abroad. The New Zealand academic Anne-Marie Brady charged Beijing with a physical intimidation campaign designed to stop her from publishing accounts of covert Chinese actions in her country.[66] All this threatens to make censorship of anti-Chinese views on campuses around the world the norm, thus threatening academic freedom.

Thanks to China's intimidation campaigns, as well as its propaganda work and influence operations, governments, think tanks, and universities around the globe have become used to treating China with kid gloves, affording it a deference rarely given to any other country. They regularly avoid contentious yet crucial topics such as human rights, labor issues, environmental devastation, or military threat. To give but one example, on the thirtieth anniversary of the Tiananmen Square massacre, in June 2019, only one think tank in Washington, DC, held a symposium on its legacy and influence on contemporary Chinese society.[67]

Yet China's reach extends beyond the academic and policy worlds, to Western popular culture as well, serving the same goal of suppressing criticism and burying negative views of the country. Chinese interests now own or are powerful partners in major US entertainment companies, including Legendary Entertainment Group and AMC